

Common Laboratory Values

High-yield adult reference ranges with an explicit reminder that laboratories and client factors vary.

CBC landmarks - WBC, hemoglobin, hematocrit, and platelet ranges vary by lab, age, sex, pregnancy, and altitude. - Interpret trends and symptoms, not a memorized number alone. - Verify the exact report range before acting.	Chemistry landmarks - Sodium, potassium, glucose, BUN, creatinine, and bicarbonate help frame fluid, renal, metabolic, and acid-base status. - Hemolysis can falsely change some results, especially potassium. - Critical values require read-back and policy-based escalation.
Memory frame - CBC = cells. - BMP/CMP = chemistry and organ clues. - Coagulation tests = clotting pathway and medication monitoring context.	

Reviewed 2026-07-13 - Source: MedlinePlus, U.S. National Library of Medicine - <https://medlineplus.gov/lab-tests/electrolyte-panel/>
Study aid only. Verify current references, instructor guidance, scope, orders, and facility policy.